

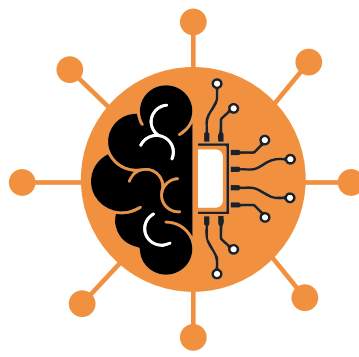
TECHIES IN TROUBLE

The New Year may not bring much cheer for techies. They are moving into a period of uncertainty marked by mass layoffs, delayed on-boarding and variable pay cuts after the hiring spree of 2021 when exorbitant hikes and joining bonuses were the norm. The tech and internet economy sectors are expected to continue seeing a few quarters of pain because of global headwinds and post-Covid-19 rationalisation of tech spending. Meanwhile, amid rising preference for gig work and the need for organisations to retain valued employees, clearer frameworks and systems around moonlighting may emerge.



Dial M for Musk

WILL WE SEE a new smartphone from *Elon Musk*? Maybe. The world's second-richest person and new chief of Twitter responded to a tweet asking what would happen if Apple and Google booted Twitter from their app stores, saying that if there was no other choice, he will make an alternative phone. Well, if the situation arises, the Tesla and SpaceX boss has all the brains, expertise and moolah to make one. While it was a misunderstanding between Musk and Apple to start with, you never know how things would unfold in the future. Should Apple be afraid?



THE MARCH OF AI

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE WILL be in focus in 2023. A report by Infosys highlighted that 81 per cent of companies deployed their first true AI system only in the past four years and 50 per cent in the last two. While most of the AI models currently function at a basic level and are driven by humans, the coming year will see the focus shift to data verification, data practices, and data strategies.

AERIAL WARFARE

ANOTHER BLOODBATH IS in the offing as a duopoly of IndiGo and Air India emerges. The country's largest carrier is adding more flights both domestically and internationally as Air India procures more aircraft to boost its fleet and ramp up operations. Here's hoping customer experience will also improve.

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MARK'S META-VERSE

Will Mark Zuckerberg quit the firm he founded? Apparently not. Facebook's parent Meta issued a clarification that it was but just a rumour. Considering the rough year Meta has had, it's little surprise the rumour was doing the rounds. Meta has seen two quarters of revenue losses, its shares have tanked more than 60 per cent in 2022 and it has laid off 11,000 employees. Key leaders, including COO Sheryl Sandberg, have left, but Zuckerberg is keeping his metaverse dreams alive.